

Case Study: Financial Performance Overview

1. Background (Business Context)

The company operates across multiple **countries**, sells multiple **products**, serves different **customer segments**, and uses **discounts** to drive sales.

Management wants a **single dashboard** to understand:

- Overall business performance
- Where revenue and profit are coming from
- Which areas are performing well or underperforming

The goal is to support **better business decisions**, not just reporting numbers.

2. Business Questions to Be Answered

Overall performance

- What is our **total revenue**?
- How many **units** did we sell?
- How much **total profit** did we generate?

Revenue trend

- Is revenue **growing or declining** over time?
- Are there months with **unusual spikes or drops**?

Segment performance

- Which **customer segments** generate the most revenue?

Discount impact

- How many units are sold under **high, medium, low, or no discount**?

Country performance

- Which countries generate the **highest revenue**?
- Which countries deliver the **highest profit**?
- Are there countries with high sales but **low profitability**?

Product performance

- Which products generate the **most revenue**?
- Which products generate the **most profit**?
- Are some products selling well but **not profitable**?

3. Key Insights (What the Data Is Telling Us)

(Keep insights simple and business-focused)

- The business is generating **strong total revenue**, but profit margins vary significantly.
- Revenue shows an **overall upward trend**, with noticeable fluctuations in certain months.
- Some customer segments drive **high revenue but lower profit**, indicating pricing or cost issues.
- A large portion of units are sold with **high discounts**, which may be impacting profitability.
- Certain countries perform well in revenue but **underperform in profit**, suggesting high costs or inefficient operations.
- A few products contribute a large share of revenue, but not all of them are **profit-efficient**.

4. Recommendations (What Should Be Done)

- Focus growth efforts on **high-profit segments**, not just high-revenue segments.
- Review and optimize the **discount strategy** to protect margins.
- Investigate countries with **low profit margins** and address cost or pricing issues.
- Prioritize **profitable products** in marketing and sales efforts.
- Improve forecasting and planning using **monthly revenue trends**.

5. Actions to Improve the Business (Concrete Next Steps)

Short-term actions

- Set **discount limits** or approval rules for high-discount sales.
- Reprice or renegotiate costs for low-margin products or markets.
- Shift sales focus toward **high-margin segments and countries**.

Medium-term actions

- Redesign product and pricing strategy based on **profit, not volume**.
- Align sales incentives with **profit contribution**, not just revenue.
- Use monthly trends to plan promotions and inventory more effectively.

Long-term actions

- Build performance targets around **profit margin and efficiency**.
- Expand in markets and segments with **consistent, sustainable profitability**.
- Continuously use dashboards to monitor performance and support decision-making.

6. One-Line Executive Summary

This dashboard helps leaders see where the business makes money, where it loses profit, and what actions to take to grow profitably.